German Idealism Reading Group

Columbia University

Faculty Sponsor: Axel Honneth

Topic: Kant's *Critique of Judgment*.

Description: We'll work through Kant's *Critique of Judgment*, which presents his views on aesthetics and teleology. Topics discussed in this book include judgment and types of judgment generally, aesthetic and non-aesthetic pleasure, the beautiful, the sublime, aesthetic judgment, teleology, art, genius, purpose, the nature and status of teleology, the teleological proof of God's existence, and the relation of aesthetics and teleology to morality.

Schedule of Readings

Week **Reading(s)**

1 The Project of the Third Critique
- Preface & Introduction (167-198 / 3-38)

Optional secondary:
- Aquila, Unity of Organism, Unity of Thought, and the Unity of the *Critique of Judgment*
- Guyer, The Unity of Nature and Freedom

2 Concepts of the Beautiful & Judgments of Taste
- Analytic of the Beautiful (203-229 / 43-75)

Optional secondary:
- Allison, *Kant's Theory of Taste* (Chapters 3-4)
- Ostaric, The Free Harmony of the Faculties and the Primacy of Imagination in Kant's Aesthetic Judgment

3 Concept of the Sublime & Further Properties of Judgments of Taste
- Analytic of the Beautiful (229-244 / 76-95)
- Analytic of the Sublime (244-247 / 97-101)

Optional secondary:
- Allison, *Kant's Theory of Taste* (Chapter 5)
- Matthews, Kant's Sublime
- Russell, Kant's Fantasy

4 The Mathematically & Dynamically Sublime
- Analytic of the Sublime (248-278 / 103-140)

Optional secondary:

- Lyotard, *Lessons on the Analytic of the Sublime* (§4-5)

5 The Deduction of Pure Aesthetic Judgments

- Deduction of Pure Aesthetic Judgments (279-303 / 141-170)

Optional secondary:

- Allison, *Kant's Theory of Taste* (Chapter 8)
- Ameriks, How to Save Kant's Deduction of Taste as Objective

6 On Art & Artists

- Deduction of Pure Aesthetic Judgments (303-336 / 170-207)

Optional secondary:

- Ostaric, Works of Genius as Sensible Exhibitions of the Idea of the Highest Good

7 The Dialectic of Aesthetic Judgment

- Dialectic of Aesthetic Judgment (337-356 / 209-232)

Optional secondary:

- Winegar, Kant's Antinomy of Taste and the Supersensible

8 Teleology in the Natural World

- Critique of Teleological Judgment (359-361 / 235-237)
- Analytic of Teleological Judgment (362-384 / 239-264)

Optional secondary:

- Kreines, The Inexplicability of Kant's *Naturzweck*
- Ginsborg, Kant on Organisms as Natural Purposes
- Fisher, Organisms and the Form of Freedom in Kant's Third *Critique*

9 The Dialectic of Teleological Judgment

- Dialectic of Teleological Judgment (385-415 / 265-300)

Optional secondary:

- Geiger, Is Teleological Judgment (Still) Necessary?

10 Methodological Significance of Teleology

- Appendix: Methodology of Teleological Judgment (416-434 / 301-321)

Optional secondary:

- Kitcher, Projecting the Order of Nature

11 The Teleological Argument for God's Existence

- Appendix: Methodology of Teleological Judgment (434-474 / 322-368)

Optional secondary:

- Ostaric, Kant's Moral Proof for God's Existence in the Third Critique

12 Final Comments on Teleology

- Appendix: Methodology of Teleological Judgment (475-485 / 369-381)